

SCAFFOLD

SUPPORTS TERTIARY HOW

FOR WHY-WHAT · WHAT-WHY

The Edge-Case Question Bank

A printed set of boundary-testing questions to run against any plan. **You borrow the signature question of the HOW orientation as a tool**, without needing the instinct behind it.

THE DRAIN

HOW-primaries generate edge cases naturally: what happens when volume doubles, when the key person leaves, when the input is malformed. For WHY-WHAT and WHAT-WHY profiles those questions do not arrive on their own, and plans ship with untested boundaries that fail in production, in front of clients.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The bank supplies the questions. Fifteen minutes running a plan against the list surfaces most of what a precision review would catch at the structural level. You do not have to imagine the failure modes; you only have to answer prepared questions honestly.

Questions from the bank

- 1 What happens when the volume doubles? When it halves?
- 2 Who owns this after launch, and do they know?
- 3 What is the first thing that breaks under time pressure?
- 4 What are we assuming stays constant that might not?
- 5 What happens at the boundaries, the first day, the last day, the handoff?
- 6 If the key person is out for two weeks, what stops?

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Run the bank before commitment.** The questions are cheapest before the plan is locked and public.
- 2 **Answer in writing, one line each.** "Fine" is not an answer. If the honest answer is "don't know," that is a finding.
- 3 **Flag the top three exposures.** Not everything needs fixing. Name the three that would hurt most.
- 4 **Assign a counter to each flag.** An owner and an action per exposure, added to the plan before it ships.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

A question bank is not a substitute for domain expertise; it finds structural gaps, not technical ones. For systems with real complexity, use the bank first, then bring the flagged items to a HOW-primary, you will have a far better conversation.

IN THE KIT

Question bank card deck

Exposure log sheet

Facilitation guide for team use

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 30 Pre-Mortem Protocol · **Tool 10** HOW-Partner Review Protocol · **Tool 27** Assumption Audit